Who Will Read It? Questions to Ask the New Care Team About Your Wife's Routines and Preferences

Fourteen questions, sorted by who can answer them, with room to write what they say.

There's an intake meeting or a first visit on the calendar, and you'll have a few minutes with each person. Bring the questions written down, ask them as they are, and write the answer under each one.

This guide doesn't answer the questions and doesn't say which matters most. That depends on the team, and the people below are the ones who know how theirs works.

The person handling her admission or intake

Whoever is setting up her care with the new team. The job title differs from place to place.

1. We've written a short page about her routines and preferences. Who should we give it to, and who else will see it?

2. Where will it be kept, so the people who are with her in the evenings and on weekends can read it too?

3. Can someone let us know once it has been received?

4. When something about her routines changes, or she tells us something new, who do we tell, and how does the page get updated?

The nurse

1. Here is our list of her allergies and the dietary instructions we were given in writing, with who gave each one. Does it match what you have on record?

2. We've kept her food likes and dislikes on a separate list. Where do preferences like these get written down, apart from her prescribed instructions?

3. There are a few things about food we couldn't place as a preference or as an instruction. Who can tell us which each one is?

The caregivers who will be with her day to day

The people who will help her in the morning and the evening.

1. What would be most useful for you to know about her mornings and evenings?

2. She has a name she likes to be called. How does that get passed along to everyone who works with her?

3. A few things help her settle when a place or a face is new. How would you like us to tell you about them?

Whoever prepares her meals

1. When are meals usually served or prepared, and who do we talk to about the times she's used to?

2. How do you learn what someone likes to eat and drink, such as how she takes her tea?

Whoever plans activities, if someone does

1. Here are the things she enjoys. What help is there if she wants to take part, and what happens on a day she'd rather not?

A care consultant

Someone who looks at the whole picture with the family, her preferences included.

1. Given what we've written about her so far, what else would you want to know about her day before the next care conversation?

What this guide doesn't do

It doesn't answer these questions, tell you which one matters most, or say what a team ought to do with your page. If an answer leaves you unsure, say so to the person in front of you.

Ready for the next step?

You have your questions, and soon some answers about who reads the page and where it's kept. The care interview gives those answers somewhere to go: it walks you through her situation area by area, her preferences alongside her care needs and the people who support her, and turns it all into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›